

Informed Consent Form

[Title of Study]

To Predict Is To Believe: Integrating Content, Context, and Creator Features For Pre-Publication Short-Form Video Engagement Prediction

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[Name of Research Project]

TokDrop

You may talk to anyone you feel comfortable talking with about the research and you can take time to reflect on whether you want to participate or not. If you do not understand some of the words or concepts, we will take time to explain them to you and you can ask questions at any time.

Purpose of the Study

You are being invited to take part in a research study. Before you decide to participate in this study, it is important that you understand why the research is being done and what your participation will involve. Please read the following information carefully and feel free to ask the researchers if there is anything that is not clear or if you need more information.

The purpose of this study is to predict how well short-form videos can capture and retain an audience's attention (engagement). Unlike other studies that only look at the video content itself, our research also looks at the creator's background and video context to make better predictions. We are inviting you to participate because you are a Filipino micro-creator, and your data will help us build a model that understands engagement patterns specific to our local context.

The data you donate will be used for (1) training and evaluating our prediction model, (2) writing the thesis manuscript, and (3) any conference presentation or publication that results from this thesis.

Study Procedures

If you choose to participate, the process will involve the following steps:

1. **Extension Export** — Install and use our TikTok Analytics Exporter Chrome extension. This is a helper tool that runs on your browser while you are logged into TikTok Studio to automate the export of your own engagement and follower history data. It will generate two CSV files containing your data.
2. **Consent and Submission**— Log in to the ALTDSI-hosted collection website (TokDrop) using the access code provided by the researchers, read and agree to this informed consent form, and upload the two exported CSV files. Before submitting, you must enable public visibility and TikTok's download permission on your posted videos, and keep these settings active until the researchers have finished downloading your videos.
3. **Video Download** — Our researchers use the video IDs contained in your submitted CSV files to download your public videos directly from TikTok using the download button on TikTok. This operates only on publicly accessible content that you have explicitly made downloadable, in compliance with TikTok's Terms of Service. The study does not scrape, access non-public data, or bypass platform access controls at any stage.
4. **Anonymization** — Our researchers strip identifying fields from your analytics (account handle, profile name, contact email) and replace your creator handle with a randomized alphanumeric ID before the data enters the model pipeline. The mapping between your original handle and the anonymized ID is stored separately from the working dataset.

Important note on your likeness: Your physical likeness in the videos will not be blurred. While our model does not use facial recognition and is not biometric, your likeness may appear in our training dataset since the original video format will be preserved.

Note on third parties appearing in your videos: Any secondary subjects (e.g., friends, family, background people) who appear in your donated videos are covered under this same consent — their faces will not be blurred either. By donating videos that feature other people, you confirm that you have the right to share those videos with our research team.

Duration

Your active involvement in running the Chrome extension and submitting the data via the ALTDSI collection website is expected to take approximately 15 to 30 minutes.

Voluntary Participation

Your participation in this study is voluntary. It is up to you whether or not you decide to participate. If you decide to participate, you will be asked to agree to this consent form on the website. After you agree to this consent form, you are still free to withdraw at any time before the final model aggregation, without giving a reason. Withdrawing from this study will not affect the relationship you have, if any, with the

researchers.

To withdraw, simply email the research team using the contact information on the first page of this form. After we verify your identity against your original donation record, your donated data will be permanently deleted from our storage.

Risks

The primary risk associated with this study is the potential exposure of your private TikTok analytics data. To minimize this risk, we are treating all participant data as sensitive. Your data will be ingested into an encrypted cloud portal, processed on an encrypted research workstation, and stored in an encrypted long-term archive. You may decline to answer any or all questions and you may withdraw your participation at any time if you choose.

Benefits

There will be no direct benefit to your participation in the study. As a side effect of running the Chrome extension, you will keep your own personal copy of your TikTok analytics in CSV form, which you may use however you wish. We also hope that the information from this study will contribute to building a more accurate, context-aware engagement prediction model that can benefit future research and the broader community of short-form video creators.

Confidentiality

Your responses and data in this research will be treated with strict confidentiality. Every effort will be made by the researchers to preserve your confidentiality, including the following:

- Assigning codes/pseudonyms for participants that will be used on all research notes and documents.
- All research data is stored as digital files only — there are no hardcopies. Files containing personal identifiers are kept on encrypted storage, password-protected, with multi-factor authentication enabled.
- Non-anonymized (identifiable) donor information is kept for a maximum of two years, and anonymized data for a maximum of three years, counted from the first publication of any result derived from the dataset or from project completion, whichever is later. After each retention window, the corresponding files are securely deleted, and the table mapping your handle to your anonymized ID is deleted at the close of the two-year window so that no path remains from anonymized data back to you.
- Research results for publication will not include any personal identifiers of the research participant, unless explicit consent was given.
- Research participants will be notified and a separate consent will be asked should any collected data be used beyond the scope of this consent.

Contact Information

If you have any questions at any time about this study, or if you experience any non-normative sensations because of participation, or to exercise your data privacy rights, you may contact the researchers whose contact information is on the first page. If you have any questions regarding your rights as a research participant, or if problems arise which you do not feel you can discuss with the Principal Investigators, please contact the Chair of the DLSU Research Ethics Review Committee at chairrerc@dlsu.edu.ph (632) 524-4611 local 513.

Consent

I have read the provided information, or it has been read to me. I have had the opportunity to ask questions about it and any questions I have asked have been answered to my satisfaction. I understand that I will be given a copy of this form, and the researcher will keep another copy on file. I consent voluntarily to be a participant in this study.

Full Name: _____

☐ I have read and understood the information above, and I voluntarily consent to participate in this study.